

4. Hospitals take great care to prevent patients becoming infected with bacteria such as MRSA. They often display posters such as the one shown below.

Protect patients from MRSA

The illustration is divided into three panels, each with a circular inset icon above it. In the first panel, a patient is in a hospital bed with a nurse standing by. The inset shows a pink circle with a surgical incision. In the second panel, a patient is in bed while another person lies on a gurney nearby, with a nurse standing between them. The inset shows a blue circle with white bacterial icons. In the third panel, a patient is in bed with a nurse, and a drip chamber is visible. The inset shows a circle with various medical supplies like pills and a bottle.

Surgery allows bacteria to enter the body

Bacteria can spread when infection control measures are not taken

Antibiotics save lives but poor prescribing practices put patients at risk

Use a combination of infection control measures with every patient to prevent infections

Use the information in the poster, and your own knowledge to answer the following question.

Describe effective control measures used to prevent MRSA and explain why infections such as MRSA have become difficult to treat. [6 QER]

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